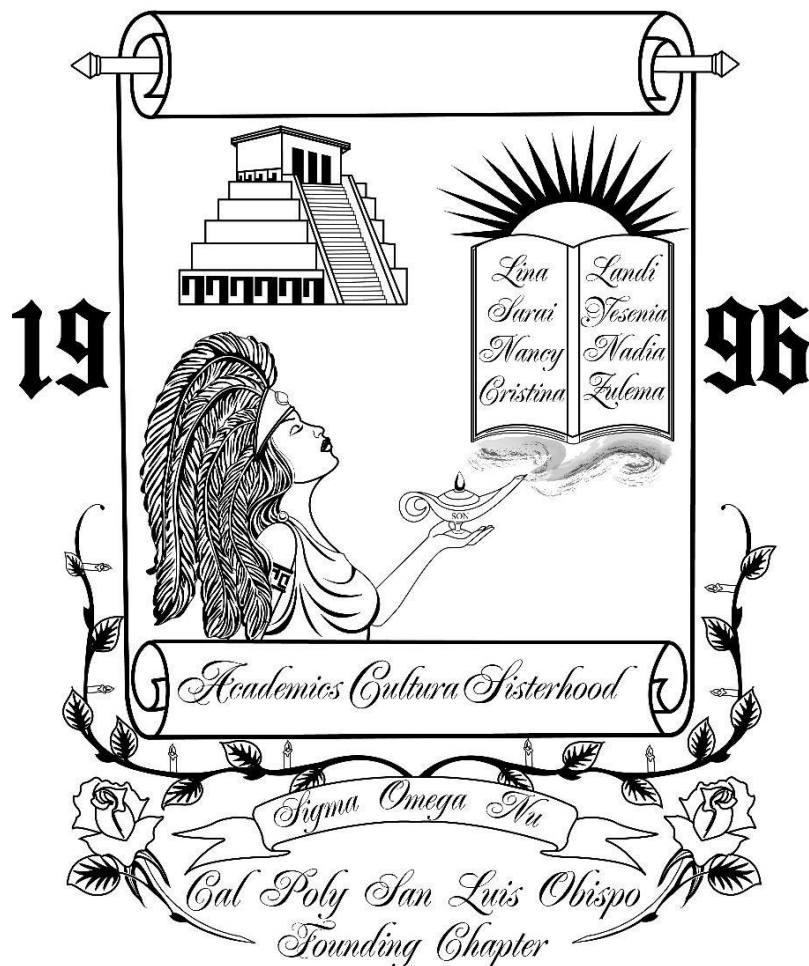


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Sigma Omega Nu

Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.



Chapter Traditions

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Table of Contents

Article I. Chapter Anniversary

Article II. Chapter Retreat

Article III. Founders' Anniversary Dinner

Article IV. Chapter Formal

Article V. Parents' & Families' Banquet

Article VI. Annual Academic or Cultural Event

Article VII. President's Gift

Article VIII. Birthdays

Article IX. Graduation Stole

Article X. Chapter Philanthropy

Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.

Chapter Traditions

Article I. Chapter Anniversary

Each year, the Chapter must celebrate its establishment anniversary by hosting a formal recognition event. The celebration must recognize the Chapter's Founding Sisters, acknowledge the history and establishment of the Chapter, and recognize the contributions and accomplishments of current Chapter members. At minimum, the following awards must be presented: Sister of the Year, Most Improved Sister, Most Inspirational Sister. The anniversary celebration may be conducted as a standalone event or in conjunction with the Chapter Formal or Parents' & Families' Banquet, provided all required recognition components are clearly included.

Article II. Chapter Retreat

Each Chapter must host one Chapter Retreat per academic year. The retreat must be open to all membership, consist of a minimum of twelve total hours, include structured bonding activities, and include structured planning sessions for the upcoming academic term and/or academic year. The required twelve hours may be held in a single day or divided across multiple consecutive days but must occur within the same retreat program.

Article III. Founders' Anniversary Dinner

Each year for the sorority's anniversary, the Chapter shall host a dinner/event open to all membership.

Article IV. Chapter Formal

The Chapter may host a formal dinner each spring quarter/semester to recognize the achievements of the Chapter of the past year. Should the Chapter have insufficient funds for a formal, a banquet/dinner may be planned. At the event, presentation of, but not limited to, the following shall be presented: recognition of the outgoing President and officers, recognition of the incoming President and officers, presentation of awards, presentation of Alpha Order, and presentation of graduation stoles. The formal may be open to all members from all chapters.

If the event is alcohol-free, Little Sisters may attend upon Active Membership's approval.

Article V. Parents' & Families' Banquet

Each Chapter must host an annual informational event for the parents and families of all Sigma Omega Nu members. The event may be conducted in-person, virtually, or in a hybrid format. The event must include a formal presentation covering the history of Sigma Omega Nu, the history of the Chapter, the mission and purpose of the sorority, and the Chapter's recent accomplishments and activities. The event is intended to educate and engage families. A purely social gathering does not satisfy this requirement. The Parents' & Families' Banquet may be held in conjunction with the Chapter Formal or Anniversary Celebration, provided the required informational presentation is clearly included as a structured component of the program.

Article VI. Annual Academic or Cultural Event

Each Chapter must host an annual event that promotes academic advancement or cultural awareness. If the Chapter hosts an academic/professional event, the event must promote academic and/or professional development and growth. If the Chapter hosts a cultural event, the event must promote Latino culture and/or the cultural backgrounds represented within the Chapter's Active membership. The event must be open to the University community and/or the surrounding community and must provide a measurable benefit to attendees.

Article VII. President's Gift

A gavel or other appropriate gift shall be presented to the outgoing President at the annual formal.

Article VIII. Birthdays

At the first General Meeting of each month, all of the Sisters celebrating a birthday that month shall be recognized. Each Active Member celebrating a birthday that month shall receive a birthday card.

Article IX. Graduation Stole

Each graduating Sister may receive a stole from the Chapter as her graduation gift. The Chapter at which the sister was initiated in, is responsible for purchasing one graduation stole AT MINIMUM per Sister. Subsequent stoles are to be requested by the Sister. Please follow the below instructions for the following graduation stoles:

Undergraduate Stole:

In order for a graduation stole to be purchased by the Chapter, the graduating sister must announce her graduation to the Active Membership at the beginning of the term in which she is to graduate. The announcement must be made by the graduating sister, presenting the Declaration of Graduation form and a letter requesting the stole to the Chapter Executive Board of the school she is enrolled in. The letter must include, at a minimum: her line information, previous degrees she has received, the school and degree of which she is receiving, her involvement in the Sorority and the length of time she has been a sister of Sigma Omega Nu. Should the Chapter Executive Board see fit, graduating sisters with outstanding balances may be required to fulfill a payment contract prior to receiving her stole.

Stoles shall be presented by the Chapter Vice President at the Annual Christmas dinner for Fall Graduates and at the Annual Spring Formal for Spring Graduates. Should the presentation of the stole at the event not be possible, then special arrangements may be made.

Graduate Stoles:

In order for a graduation stole to be purchased by the Chapter, the graduating sister must announce her graduation to the Active Membership at the beginning of the term in which she is to graduate. The announcement must be made by the graduating sister, presenting the Declaration of Graduation form and a letter requesting the stole to the Chapter Executive Board of the school she is enrolled in. If a Chapter is not at the school she is enrolled in, then the Declaration of Graduation form and a letter must be presented to the Executive Board of the Chapter she was initiated in. The letter must include, at a minimum: her line information, previous degrees she has received, the school and degree of which she is receiving, her involvement in the Sorority and the length of time she has been a sister of Sigma Omega Nu. Should the Chapter Executive Board see fit, graduating sisters with outstanding balances may be required to fulfill a payment contract prior to receiving her stole.

The letter mentioned above will be discussed and voted on by the Chapter Executive Board. Once the decision has been made, the sister will be notified within two weeks. Should the Chapter deny the request, a letter stating their reasoning should be included in their response to the Sister.

Should a sister continue her educational studies and her initiating Chapter denies her request, she can request a stole from National Board based on her achievement in receiving degrees. National Board will purchase two stoles per sister max; one for the Master Degree Level and another for the Doctorate/Juris Doctor (JD) Degree. The Sister must submit the letter of denial from her initiating Chapter, as well as present a letter requesting the stole to the National Executive Board at least 3 months prior to graduation. The letter will be discussed and voted on by the Executive Board; once the decision has been made, the sister will be notified within two weeks. The letter must include, at a minimum: her line information, previous degrees she has received, the school and degree of which she is receiving, her involvement in the Sorority and the length of time she has been a sister of Sigma Omega Nu. Should the National Executive Board see fit, graduating sisters with outstanding balances may be required to fulfill a payment contract prior to receiving her stole.

Design:

The color specifications for the stole are the following depending on degree level and to match our official sweaters.

Bachelor Degree: The stole shall be made of Black material with Old Gold trim and the tips of the stole being slant shaped. The approximate measurements of the stole shall be 62 inches in length and 5 inches in width. On the right side, the Greek letters of ΣΩΝ shall be blocked vertically in Cardinal with Old Gold

outline. On the left side, the Sorority Crest shall be embroidered over the heart. The graduating sister has the option of additional embroidery such as graduating year, school name and line information, but the additional embroidery will not be paid by the Sorority.

Master Degree: The stole shall be made of Cardinal material with Old Gold trim and the tips of the stole being slant shaped. The approximate measurements of the stole shall be 62 inches in length and 5 inches in width. On the right side, the Greek letters of ΣΩΝ shall be blocked vertically in Black with Old Gold outline. On the left side, the Sorority Crest shall be embroidered over the heart. The graduating sister has the option of additional embroidery such as graduating year, school name and line information, but the additional embroidery will not be paid by the Sorority.

Doctorate/Juris Doctor (JD) Degree: The stole shall be made of Old Gold material with Black trim and the tips of the stole being slant shaped. The approximate measurements of the stole shall be 62 inches in length and 5 inches in width. On the right side, the Greek letters of ΣΩΝ shall be blocked vertically in Cardinal with Black outline. On the left side, the Sorority Crest shall be embroidered over the heart. The graduating sister has the option of additional embroidery such as graduating year, school name and line information, but the additional embroidery will not be paid by the Sorority.

Article X. Chapter Philanthropy

During the Prospective Chapter Pledgeship process, a Chapter Philanthropy must be picked. Following Chapter Establishment, the Founding Sisters must submit a proposal to the National Board stating the desired philanthropy and their reasoning for having chosen that organization.

Protocol for Changing the Chapter Philanthropy

After Chapter Establishment, a change to the Chapter Philanthropy may be proposed under the following conditions:

1. A written proposal must be submitted to the Chapter's Executive Board outlining:
 - a. The reason for the proposed change;
 - b. Information regarding the proposed new philanthropy;
 - c. An explanation of how the new organization aligns with the Sorority's mission and objectives;
 - d. A transition plan for concluding support of the current philanthropy, if applicable.
2. Upon receipt of the proposal, the Chapter's Executive Board must issue formal written notification to all Founding Sisters. Such notification must:
 - a. Include a copy of the full proposal;
 - b. Provide the date, time, and location of the meeting at which the proposal will be voted on;
 - c. Allow no fewer than fourteen calendar days for review prior to the vote.
3. Founding Sisters must be given the opportunity to submit written feedback and/or attend the meeting at which the proposal will be discussed and voted upon. Attendance may be in person or via approved virtual means when available.
4. The proposal must be approved by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of Active Members.
5. Upon Chapter approval, the complete proposal package shall be submitted to the National Board for review and final approval. The submission must include:
 - a. The full written proposal;

- b. Documentation of the Chapter vote, including vote count;
 - c. Copies of any written feedback submitted by Founding Sisters;
 - d. Confirmation that proper notice was issued to the Founding Sisters
- 6. The change may not take effect until written approval is received from the National Board.
- 7. A Chapter may not propose a change to its philanthropy more than once within a two academic year period, unless exceptional circumstances exist and are approved by the National Board.